

Paper & ink, with a green pen for approval.

A warm, calm system for an app that handles someone's whole business. The palette does the safety talking: **green acts**, **amber suggests**, **terracotta warns**. Everything else is paper.

1 Principles

Calm, not a firehose

Paper backgrounds, hairline borders, one accent at a time. No red badges except a true count of things waiting.

Color = consequence

Green for safe, reversible actions. Amber for suggestions waiting on you. Terracotta only when something leaves the house (sends, deletes, charges).

Show the sources

Every AI output carries source chips and a "why this" path. Monospace marks the file underneath — the ownership signature.

Plain language first

"Approve — put in my Gmail drafts", never "Execute". Warm, brief, no exclamation marks. Technical detail is one toggle away, never the default.

2 Color

PAPER — SURFACES

#E9E3D6 canvas / desk	#FBF8F1 app surface	#FFFEFA card	#F7F2E7 panel / rail
#F3EEE2 sidebar	#EEE8D9 control track	#ECE5D2 status pill	#E7DFCA nav active
#E6DECB border	#EFE9DA hairline / row	#E0D7C1 chip border	#D8CFB9 button border

GREEN — ACTS (SAFE, REVERSIBLE)

#2F5D48 primary action	#244938 hover	#E6EDE2 badge tint	#2F8A5B success ✓, sync dot
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Use for: approve, open, review, booked calendar events, "reply drafted" badges, links. Never for anything that sends or deletes.

INK — TEXT

#29251E headings, emphasis	#3D3830 body / email text	#57503F secondary, nav idle
#6E6656 subtitles	#948A75 meta, timestamps	#A89D85 overlines, counts

Contrast floor: #948A75 is the lightest ink allowed on #FBF8F1 for meaningful text; #A89D85 only for overlines ≥ 700 weight and decorative counts.

AMBER — SUGGESTS (WAITING ON YOU)

#8F6E1F amber ink	#C9A24B hold dash	#F4EBD2 badge tint	#F9F2E3 suggestion bg	#E8D9B5 suggestion border
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Use for: memory updates, suggested additions, calendar holds, "update suggested" badges, highlight marks in text.

TERRACOTTA — WARNS (IRREVERSIBLE)

#B4512E warn ink, counts	#C0703F email source dot	#F6E7DE badge tint	#EBD5C6 card border	#E0BDA9 checkbox border
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Use for: "sends an email" badges, overdue counts, the "now" line on the calendar, notification badge. Outline buttons only — terracotta is never a filled button.

SOURCE-DOT SEMANTICS

- Email / external message
- Calendar / client memory
- Policy / offer / document
- System OK / sync

3 Typography

Good morning Mara

Newsreader 500 · 32–40

Open loops

page title · 21–24

Around your week

rail title · 19

"Reschedules are free with more than 24 hours' notice."

quote · italic 14–15

Card title — Instrument Sans 650

13.5–15 · 650

Body copy explains what happened and what will happen next, in one or two sentences.

13–14 · 400 · 1h 1.5+

SECTION OVERLINE

10.5–12 · 700 · +0.09em

memozy/offers/founder-coaching.md

IBM Plex Mono · 10.5–12

ROLES

Newsreader — greetings, page titles, quoted memory. The human voice.
Instrument Sans — all UI: labels, body, buttons, badges.
IBM Plex Mono — file paths, YAML, "open the hood". The ownership signature; never for friendly copy.

VOICE

Address the user by first name. Say what was used and what happens next. Buttons name outcomes: *"Approve — put in my Gmail drafts"*, *"Read, then send..."*. No exclamation marks, no emoji, no jargon before the toggle.

GEOMETRY

Spacing on a 4px grid; blocks step 8 → 12 → 16 → 20 → 32.
Radii: 999px pills · 12px cards · 8–9px buttons · 7px list rows & events · 4px checkboxes.
Shadow: cards 0 1px 2px rgba(42,38,32,.05); windows 0 24px 60px rgba(42,38,32,.28).

4 Buttons & actions

Approve draft

Read & edit

Snooze

Read, then send...

Why this? →

Approve

Edit

✓ Approve

+ Add an FAQ

Friendly view

Raw file

AI / Review · 4

Inbox · 18

Warmer

RULES

Primary (green fill) — one per card, max. Safe & reversible only.
Secondary (outline) — everything else: edit, snooze, dismiss.
Danger (terracotta outline) — irreversible; label names the consequence and ends in an ellipsis because a confirmation always follows. Never filled, never the default focus.
Link action — green 600, with a → for navigation.
Segmented / filter pills — 999px on the #EEE8D9 track.
Sizes: L 13px/8×16 · M 12px/6×12 · S 11.5px/3×9. Hit target ≥ 32px in dense lists, 36px+ elsewhere.

5 Badges, chips & pills

KIND BADGES — WHAT THE AI DID

REPLY DRAFTED	APPROVED	MEMORY UPDATE	UPDATE SUGGESTED	BOOKKEEPING
SENDS AN EMAIL	PREP BRIEF	CONTEXT USED	2 HOLDS	ALWAYS ASKS FIRST

SOURCE CHIPS — WHAT THE AI USED

Jonas's email	Your calendar	Scheduling policy
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PROVENANCE, COUNTS, PEOPLE & STATUS

from Mail	from Workflow	Priya Nair	6	2	All local · synced 2 min ago
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RULES

Kind badges — 10–11px, 700, uppercase, +0.04em, 999px. Tint follows consequence: green = prepared/safe, amber = suggestion, terracotta = irreversible, neutral #EEE8D9 = informational. Dashed border only for calendar holds.
Source chips — always ≥ 1 on any AI output; dot color follows the source-dot semantics. Clickable → opens the source.
Count badges — terracotta only in the main nav ("things waiting"); amber for suggestion counts; plain #948A75 text for neutral counts.
Status pill — one per screen, bottom of sidebar. Names the transport (IMAP · Infomaniak) or "All local".

6 Cards — the approval family

APPROVAL CARD — SAFE (GREEN PRIMARY)

SENDS AN EMAIL

Feldmann GmbH · Invoice 14 days overdue

The consequence is stated in the body, in terracotta: **approving this sends the email** — read it first.

Read, then send...

Wait a week

CONSEQUENCE CARD — SENDS SOMETHING

Same anatomy, terracotta border + badge, **no green fill anywhere** — the eye can't autopilot-approve.

SUGGESTION CARD — MEMORY UPDATE

MEMORY UPDATE

Pricing › Group Coaching Workshop

CHF 4,900 flat → CHF 2,200 flat from 1 January 2027

Approve

Edit

Dismiss

Amber ground #F9F2E3 — floats on any surface. Shows the change as a strikethrough diff, names the target page, always Approve / Edit / Dismiss.

7 Navigation — sidebar & ICM tree

ML Mara Lindt Coaching
Local workspace

Today

6

Mail

4

Memory

2

Offers

3

Clients

9

Policies

1

All local · synced 2 min ago

>_ Open the hood

RULES

Sidebar is 236px, #F3EEE2, with three groups: **Daily** (Today, Mail, Calendar, Chat, Tasks), **Assistant** (Workflows, Memory + tree, Files), **System** (Sources, Audit log).
Item: 15px stroke icon (1.5px, round caps) + 13.5px label. Active = #E7DFCA fill, ink 600. Idle = #57503F, hover = #ECE5D2.
ICM tree mirrors icm/ exactly: indented 17px behind a 1px #E0D7C1 guide line, 12.5px rows, page counts right-aligned, amber count = pending suggestion inside. Tree active row uses the deeper #EEE5CF.
Anchors, always: the status pill (one truth about where data lives) and the monospace ">_ Open the hood" as the very last row.

8 Lists & rows

MAIL LIST ITEM

Priya Nair
Inquiry — leadership coaching
Hi Mara, a former colleague recommended you...

Yesterday

REPLY DRAFTED

1 MEMORY NOTE

Jonas Wetter
Moving our Tuesday session

8:02

Selected = #FFFEFA fill + 3px green left bar. Status badges show the assistant's work at a glance — never more than two.

TASK ROW

☐ Give Feldmann a September workshop date

from Memory

Clients › Feldmann — open loops · 3 weeks old

Draft options

DENSE QUEUE ROW (1B PATTERN)

☒ REPLY

Jonas Wetter

Reschedule → offered Thu 14:00 / Fri 10:00

3 sources

✓ Approve

✓ Moved 4 newsletters to Reading — your archive rule

7:05 · Undo

Audit / "done automatically" rows: green check, 0.75 opacity, timestamp + Undo right-aligned. Never expandable-looking — they're receipts, not tasks.

STRUCTURED FACTS (MEMORY PAGE)

Price

CHF 2,400 for the package

Sessions

6 × 75 minutes, every two weeks

Label column #948A75 / value 600 ink. Facts the assistant may quote verbatim live here, not in prose.

9 Calendar events & chat

EVENT VOCABULARY

The diagram illustrates the lifecycle of a session through five states, each represented by a colored box with a specific icon and text:

- Session-booked** (Green box): 11:00 - 12:15 - Zoom
- Hold-assistant** (Orange box): offered in draft
- Block-deep work** (Brown box): protected
- Routine-with assistant** (White box): weekly review
- Session-moved** (Grey box): → holds Thu / Fri

A timeline at the bottom shows the progression from **now** to **line**, with a red dot indicating the current position.

Solid fill + 3px left bar = real. Dashed 1.5px border = the assistant's hand — nothing dashed is ever committed. A hold converts to a booking only via an approval. Past events at 0.55 opacity.

CHAT BUBBLES

A screenshot of a web application interface. At the top, a dark green banner contains the text "What's still open with Feldmann?". Below this, a light gray box displays the message "Invoice 2026-118 is 14 days overdue — a reminder is waiting in Today." At the bottom, there are two buttons: "Invoice 2026-118" with a yellow dot icon, and "Clients > Feldmann" with a green dot icon.

User: green fill, 14/14/4/14 radius. Assistant: card + border, mirrored radius, source chips underneath every substantive answer. Memory-update suggestion cards (\$6) render inline in the thread, full width of the bubble column.

INPUT

Ask anything, or tell it something new... Send

10 Panels, provenance & the hood

RAIL CARD ("WHY THIS DRAFT")

● JONAS'S EMAIL • 8:02

"Could we move Tuesday? Something came up at work."

[View email →](#)

Rails are 290–340px, #F7F2E7, Newsreader title. Each source gets its own card: dot-colored underline, italic serif quote (verbatim only), link to the origin.

ASSISTANT STRIP (ON A MAIL THREAD)

● WHAT YOUR ASSISTANT DID WITH THIS

REPLY DRAFTED Warm intro — waiting in Today. Review →

One row per action: badge → sentence → link. Attach under the content it refers to, never above it — the human's material always comes first.

THE HOOD – RAW FILE PREVIEW

```
RAW FILE · FIRST LINES

id: inquiry_triage
safety: { send: never, approval: required }
... 61 more lines · switch to raw file
```

Progressive disclosure: friendly view default, raw one toggle away, YAML keys in amber. The ownership card (#ECE5D2) appears wherever files are visible.

11 Workflow timeline & window chrome

- 1 Watch the "AI / Review" label**
Plain-language description of what the step does.
`trigger: imap.label`
- 2 Wait for your approval** ALWAYS ASKS FIRST
The approval step is always last, always green.

Numbered ink circles (24px) on a 1.5px guide; the final approval step is the only green circle. Each step pairs a friendly title with its monospace YAML reference right-aligned — the two layers of the same truth.

LAYOUT GRID

Sidebar 236 · optional list pane 250–340 · main flexible (content max 560–660) · optional rail 290–340. Page headers: underline date → Newsreader greeting/title → one-line subtitle. Section overlines separate content groups; never boxed section headers.

Companion to [Admin Cockpit.dc.html](#) — every specimen above is lifted from those screens. Newsreader · Instrument Sans · IBM Plex Mono, via Google Fonts.